TwitchWatcher

Setup Guide — Getting Your Twitch API Credentials

Before using TwitchWatcher you need a free Twitch Developer account and a registered app. This sounds scarier than it is — it takes about 5 minutes and you only do it once.

Step 1 — Log Into the Twitch Developer Console

- Go to **https://dev.twitch.tv/console**
- Click **Log In with Twitch** in the top right corner
- Sign in with your normal Twitch account

Step 2 — Register a New App

- Once logged in, click **Applications** in the left sidebar
- Click the **Register Your Application** button

Fill in the form:

- **Name:** Pick any name that does **not** contain the word "Twitch" — their console rejects those. Use your username or a nickname (e.g. *FrogWatch*). This is just an internal label and does not affect how TwitchWatcher works.
- **OAuth Redirect URLs:** Type `http://localhost` and click Add
- **Category:** Select Application Integration
- **Client Type:** Select Confidential
- Check the **I'm not a robot** box
- Click **Create**

Step 3 — Get Your Client ID

- You'll be taken back to the Applications list
- Click **Manage** next to the app you just created
- You'll see a **Client ID** — a long string of letters and numbers
- Copy it and keep it handy

Step 4 — Generate Your Client Secret

- On the same page, scroll down and click **New Secret**
- A popup will warn you — click **OK**
- Your **Client Secret** will appear — **copy it immediately**

■ Twitch only shows the Client Secret ONCE. If you close the page without copying it, you will need to generate a new one.

Step 5 — Enter Your Credentials in TwitchWatcher

- Open TwitchWatcher
- Open the **Settings** menu → **Twitch Credentials…**

- Paste your **Client ID** into the Client ID field
- Paste your **Client Secret** into the Client Secret field
- Click **Save**

Your Client Secret is stored securely in **Windows Credential Manager** — the same encrypted vault your browser uses for saved passwords. It is never written to a file on your computer.

Step 6 — Add Your First Streamer

- Click the **Streamers** tab
- Type a Twitch username in the Username field
- Optionally assign a **Group** (e.g. "Friends", "Gamers", "Drops") to keep things organised
- Choose a **Mode** for how you want to be alerted: *Open when live*, *Open on Drops* (only when their title mentions drops), *Notify only*, or *Notify on Drops*
- Click **Add** or press Enter

Step 7 — Start Watching

- Click **Start Watching** at the bottom of the app
- TwitchWatcher will check Twitch every 5 minutes (configurable in **Preferences**)
- When a streamer goes live you'll get a Windows notification and their channel opens in your browser

Optional — Autostart

If you want TwitchWatcher to start watching automatically every time you open it:

- Go to the **Preferences** tab
- Tick **Start watching automatically when app opens**
- Click **Save Preferences**

To have TwitchWatcher open automatically every time Windows starts, also tick **Launch TwitchWatcher when Windows starts** in **Preferences** and Save. Pair it with the option above and it runs hands-free — no need to remember to open it.

FAQ

What should I name my app on the Twitch Developer Console?

Twitch does not allow the word "Twitch" in the app name, so "TwitchWatcher" will be rejected. Use anything else — your username or a nickname like *FrogWatch*. It is just an internal label and does not affect how TwitchWatcher works.

Do I need to build a website or host anything?

No. The `http://localhost` redirect URL is just a required placeholder — nothing actually runs there. TwitchWatcher talks to Twitch's API directly from your PC.

Troubleshooting

"Auth error: 403"

Your Client ID or Secret is wrong. Double-check you copied them correctly with no extra spaces. Open **Settings** → **Twitch Credentials…**, re-enter both, and save again.

"Auth error: 401"

Your token expired or your Secret was regenerated on the Twitch side. Go to dev.twitch.tv, generate a new Secret, paste it into **Settings** → **Twitch Credentials…**, and save.

Windows blocked the app / said it's a virus

TwitchWatcher is not signed with a paid developer certificate, so Windows Defender may flag it as unknown publisher. This is normal for indie tools. Click **More info** → **Run anyway** to proceed. TwitchWatcher only connects to Twitch's official API.

Notifications aren't appearing

Go to Windows Settings → System → Notifications and make sure notifications are enabled.

I moved the app and lost my settings

Your settings are saved in `twitch_watcher_config.json` in the same folder as the app. Move that file to the new folder too. Your Client Secret is stored in Windows Credential Manager and carries over automatically.

Privacy & Security

- TwitchWatcher only communicates with `https://id.twitch.tv` and `https://api.twitch.tv`
- Your credentials are stored locally on your machine only
- No data is collected, no accounts are created, nothing is sent to any third party
- Source code is available on GitHub for anyone to review